

GT DESIGNZ LIMITED

Fire Statement

3 Woden Road, Wolverhampton
WV10 0AU

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Proposal Summary

The Statement has been prepared in support of the planning application of 3 Woden Road, Wolverhampton, WV10 0AU for establishing the HMO Class C4 (For 6 persons).

Site and Surrounding Area

This is a end of terrace property.

Fire Safety Assessment

Fire Prevention

- The electrical circuits, fittings and equipment throughout the house are in good condition.
- The electrical installation to be checked regularly by a competent electrician (NICEIC or ECA approved) and act quickly on any recommendations that are made.
- Install circuit breakers and prevent overloading of sockets by ensuring that adaptors are not needed.
- The gas installation (i.e. the gas pipework, meters, gas fires, cookers, boilers, water heaters and flues) to be checked, and serviced at least once a year by a Gas Safe registered gas fitter. This is a legal requirement under the Gas Safety (Installation and Use) Regulations.
- A copy of the safety certificate to each resident within 28 days, and a copy to be given to any new residents before they move in.
- Ensure that heaters and cookers are fixed in a position where they will not set fire to curtains, bedding or furnishings.
- All upholstered furniture (such as settees, armchairs, bed bases and mattresses) has sewn-in labels showing that it has fire-resistant filling and covers. This is a legal requirement under the Furniture and Furnishings (Fire) (Safety) Regulations 1988 and the Furniture and Furnishings (Fire) (Safety) (Amendment) Regulations 1993.
- Prohibit the use of portable gas or paraffin heaters in the house. Do not store highly flammable materials in the house (such as paint, thinners, LPG cylinders, paraffin or petrol).

- Do not store large quantities of combustible materials such as cardboard boxes or newspapers, in understairs cupboards, cellars, or in the loft.

Informing the residents of the following information and ensure they understand the importance of:

- smoking in bed or when drowsy
- careless use of candles or joss sticks
- overloading electrical sockets
- having trailing cables
- leaving a chip pan or frying pan unattended, or over-full of oil or fat
- placing clothes to dry over or near heaters

The importance of a bedtime fire safety routine:

- turning off the cooker
- unplugging electrical appliances (except those designed to remain on)
- making sure that no cigarettes or candles are left burning
- closing all doors

In the event of a fire the tenant should be advised that:

- Do not attempt to fight fires that have already taken hold - evacuate yourself from the house. If you share the house with other people sound the alarm as you make your escape.
- Do not try to rescue belongings or pets. Your life and the lives of other residents are too precious to risk.
- Telephone the Fire Brigade on 999 immediately from a place of safety. Speak slowly and try to be calm answering the questions you are asked. If you think there may be someone left in the building inform the 999 operator

Design Consideration

The HMO's design, construction and condition must limit the spread of fire and smoke and provide a safe and ready means of escape. There must be adequate fire protection to the means of escape and between each unit of accommodation, with appropriate detection and alarm systems provided. Emergency lighting and fire blankets shall be provided where necessary.

- Every risk room (bedroom, living room, kitchen) and circulation space needs a mains wired detector/alarm. These will detect fires at the earliest opportunity and ensure that warning is sounded.
- The detectors normally need to be linked so that everyone in the house is alerted when the alarm sounds.
- Emergency lighting illuminates the escape route to show persons the way out if the electricity supply is interrupted.
- The stairwell, landing, and hall are kept clear of obstruction so that people can get out without tripping.
- The escape route shall be protected to ensure people can exit the property safely. Generally, this will mean the partitions from risk rooms to the escape route giving 30 minutes fire resistance. Between rooms or in certain low risk premises partitions may be acceptable if they are of sound traditional construction.
- All risk rooms (bedroom, living room, kitchen) need 30 minute fire resisting doors with smoke and heat seals and self-closing devices. The fire door slows down the spread of smoke and fire so people can move past it to exit the house. Fire doors are provided to protect the route of escape and should never be wedged open.
- The methods of locking or fastening risk rooms and escape room doors should not prevent them from being opened internally without the use of a key.
- Fire blankets and fire extinguishers can be useful in tackling small fires, and preventing their uncontrolled spread, but on balance it is best to encourage people to get out of the house quickly and call the Fire Service. There are injuries every year as a result of ineffective or inappropriate use of equipment. Where equipment is provided, all residents must receive proper instruction in

the use of it. Therefore, whilst fire blankets should be provided to all cooking facilities normally there will be no requirement for fire extinguishers.

Travel distances

Travel distances within HMOs are an important matter. In the event of fire, occupiers need to be reasonably sure that they can reach a place of safety within reasonable time. The layout of the premises needs to be such that occupiers can quickly find their way across the room they are in and then through any protected route to the final exit. This must be achieved despite possible heat, flames and most importantly smoke. Smoke is often toxic but can also reduce visibility both by fogging and by causing irritation to the eyes. Occupiers need to be able to get through the escape route with a minimum of exposure to these hazards particularly by inhalation.

The distance between any point on the premises and a place of relative safety should ideally be a maximum of 9 metres. A place of relative safety would, for example, be a protected route within the building.

Detailed Fire Precautions Requirements

1 Detection/ Warning

A system of mains powered interlinked automatic smoke and heat detectors to form a grade D LD2 system in accordance with BS 5839 part 6 (or equivalent). System to incorporate interlinked smoke alarms with integral battery back-up throughout the escape route. Interlinked smoke alarms with integral battery back-up in each bedroom, communal living room, and cellar. Interlinked heat alarms with integral battery back-up in communal kitchens.

2 Emergency Lighting

Conventional lighting is required throughout the escape route. Emergency lighting may be appropriate if the route is complex or there is no effective borrowed light. The requirement for, and the degree of emergency lighting will depend on the design of the property and the location of the escape route and form part of the overall Fire Risk Assessment. Where considered necessary it must be designed and installed in accordance with BS 5266 part 1 (or equivalent).

3 Escape Route

The escape route should allow occupants from all parts of the building to reach a place of safety outside without passing through a higher fire risk area. The route should be kept free of obstructions and combustible materials at all times, and the walls and ceilings should be free of flammable materials such as polystyrene ceiling tiles and heavy flock wall paper. At least 30 minute fire resistance should be provided to the route. There is no requirement for additional fire separation between rooms, but the walls and floors should be of sound traditional construction. Electric and Gas meters located in the escape route should either be re-located or contained within fire resisting construction to provide at least 30 minute fire resistance.

4 Fire Doors

A fire door of at least 30 minute fire resistance must be installed in each doorway leading onto the escape route, except bathrooms and WC's (unless they contain a fire risk such as a boiler).

5 Security of Doors

Security devices on bedrooms and final exit doors must be capable of being opened from the inside without the use of keys, i.e. Yale type or thumb turn locks.⁶

6 Fire Blankets

A fire blanket should be provided in each area where there are cooking facilities, and be wall mounted 1.5m high adjacent to an exit door and away from the cooking appliance. These must comply with BS 6575 (or equivalent).

7 Fire Extinguishers

Where the risk assessment indicates that fire extinguishers are required they shall be multipurpose extinguishers and shall be located as requested by the risk assessment. If provided they shall be maintained in working order and residents instructed in their use.

8 Other Recommendations

Fire doors across escape routes, communal kitchens, and boiler rooms should be marked 'Fire door keep shut' Reference should be made to 'The Management of Houses in Multiple Occupation (England) Regulations 2006' - in particular regulation 4 relates to the maintenance of fire fighting equipment and alarms.